How do they control their launch direction? Because the critical orbit is so unstable, a small rocket blast is sufficient to send the *Endurance* off it. And if the blast is ignited at precisely the right location along the critical orbit and has precisely the right strength, it will send the *Endurance* in precisely the desired direction (Figure 27.9).

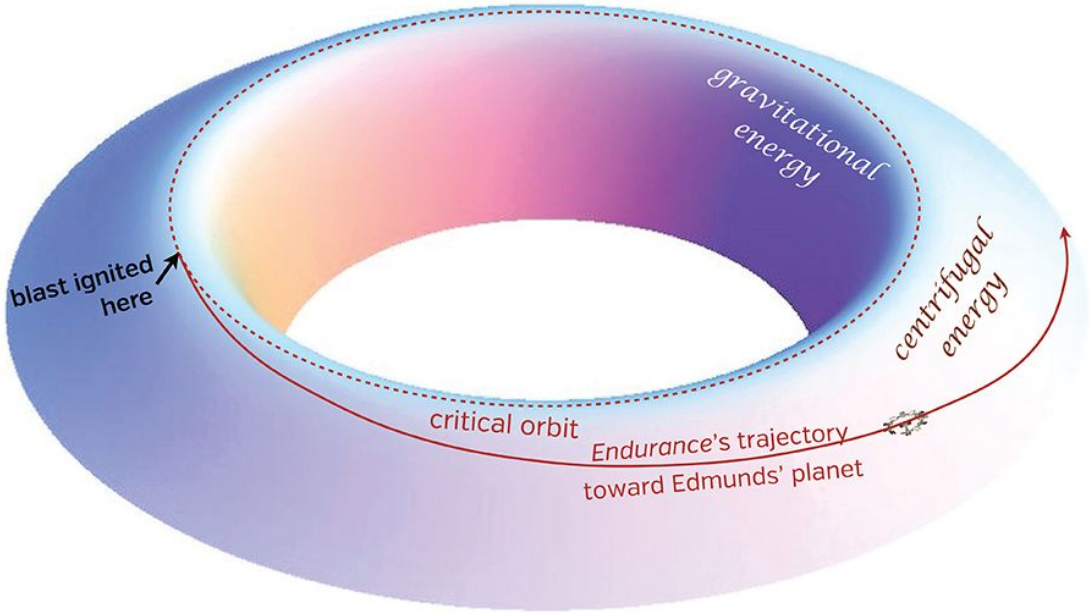


Fig. 27.9. The *Endurance*'s trajectory off the critical orbit, toward Edmunds' planet. *[Image of the* Endurance *is from* Interstellar.*]*

Actually, Figure 27.9 may leave you unconvinced that Brand and Case can launch in any direction they wish. That's because it doesn't capture the critical orbit's three-dimensional structure. For that, see Figure 27.10.